



Gmail hacked?

A group of hackers have hacked Gmail and other Android apps with a success rate of 92% and will be releasing their findings soon.



Moon landing was real

Amidst the moon landing conspiracy, this is another way to prove that it wasn't a hoax. <http://dgit.in/MoonLand>



Examples of ISIS propaganda shared through social media

stint on social media even though its Twitter handles are regularly shut down by administrators. HSMPress, a Twitter handle associated with Al-Shabab, the Somali arm of Al-Qaeda was very prolific until it was shut down in January of last year. Al Qaeda's media division, As-Sahab has also been known to create and share YouTube videos that both teach combat information to viewers as well as spread propaganda.

ISIS

ISIS, or the Islamic State of Iraq and Syria, has been in news recently as a ruthless terrorist organisation that's cutting a swathe through Iraq and Syria. ISIS has been particularly cunning with its use of social media, especially Twitter. Through an app 'The Dawn of Good Tidings' released on the Android Play Store



A gathering of Al-Shabab militants in Somalia (AP/Farah Abdi Warsameh via Mint News)

(now no longer available, at least in India), ISIS was able to send tweets from the accounts of anyone who used the app in a way that passed under the radar of Twitter's spam detection filters. ISIS has also been known to organize concerted hash tag campaigns making sure that thanks to its sympathisers, certain hash tags are forced to trend on Twitter, ensuring retweets and visibility.

ISIS (and its collaborators) have also tried to expand their group's image by selling t-shirts, hoodies and toys emblazoned with their message and logos on Facebook. The social network has since put an end to that by banning the sale of ISIS merchandise on Facebook.

Taliban

The Tehreek-i-Taliban Pakistan or the Pakistani Taliban was trying to recruit people who would write and design propaganda including videos through its Facebook page. However, it was shut down in 2012. Instead now, there is an anaemic Facebook page for the Jamaat Ud-Dawa, the political arm of the Lashkar-e-Taiba, that also has connections with the Taliban. In its prime, the Taliban was apparently using profile photos of pretty women to get information out of Australian soldiers on Facebook, as well.

The Taliban keeps a pretty active presence on Twitter and most of its official news and statements are pumped out from multiple accounts such as "zabihmujahid" who claims to be the 'official spokesman' for the Taliban, "almerahweb" which claims to be the 'official website' of the Taliban, and "ABalkhi".

The Future & How it Affects You

As the reach of social networks expands to every nook and corner of the planet, it is only inevitable that more and more radicals and terrorists will make their way towards social networks. As a result, governments and security agencies from around the



The Jamaat Ud-Dawa Facebook page



The Twitter exchange between American Airlines & a Dutch teenager who pretended to be a terrorist.



A post by Al-Qaeda on Twitter.

world will take even more stringent measures to keep a watch on social networks which means that even when chatting with your friends and family, you may have to be careful of what you type. We've already seen cases where social network users have been arrested because their tweets/posts were considered threatening.

However, it's not all doom and gloom because for every ISIS, that is hyper-efficient with the way it deploys its social media strategy, there are hundreds of other terrorists that are terrible at using social media to cause any harm. And just to feel better, you could head over to the Al-Qaeda parody account on Twitter and have a good laugh.